

SHORT COMMAND NAMES

When I started learning the Linux operating system, I was surprised to find that the Windows `copy` command I knew well was named `cp` on Linux. The name “copy” was much more readable than “cp.” Was a terse, cryptic name really worth saving two characters’ worth of typing?

As I gained more experience in the command line, I realized the answer is a firm “yes.” We read source code more often than we write it, so using verbose names for variables and functions helps. But we type commands into the command line more often than we read them, so in this case, the opposite is true: short command names make the command line easier to use and reduce strain on your wrists.

Move Files and Folders with `move` and `mv`

On Windows, you can move a source file or folder to a destination folder by running `move [source file or folder] [destination folder]`. The `mv [source file or folder][destination folder]` command does the same thing on macOS and Linux.

Here’s an example in a Linux terminal window:

```
al@ubuntu:~/someFolder$ ls
hello.py  someSubFolder
al@ubuntu:~/someFolder$ mv hello.py someSubFolder
al@ubuntu:~/someFolder$ ls
someSubFolder
al@ubuntu:~/someFolder$ cd someSubFolder/
al@ubuntu:~/someFolder/someSubFolder$ ls
hello.py
```

The *hello.py* file has moved from *~/someFolder* to *~/someFolder/someSubFolder* and no longer appears in its original location.

Rename Files and Folders with `ren` and `mv`

Running `ren [file or folder] [new name]` renames the file or folder on Windows, and `mv [file or folder] [new name]` does so on macOS and Linux. Note that you can use the `mv` command on macOS and Linux for moving *and* renaming a file. If you supply the name of an existing folder for the second argument, the `mv` command moves the file or folder there. If you